

Thunar - Custom Actions

 docs.xfce.org/xfce/thunar/custom-actions

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Thunar allows users to add custom actions to the file and folder context menus (by the use of the `thunar-uca` plugin, part of the Thunar distribution, in the `plugins/` subdirectory). You can set up new actions in the **Custom Actions** dialog, available via the **Configure custom actions...** item in the **Edit** menu.

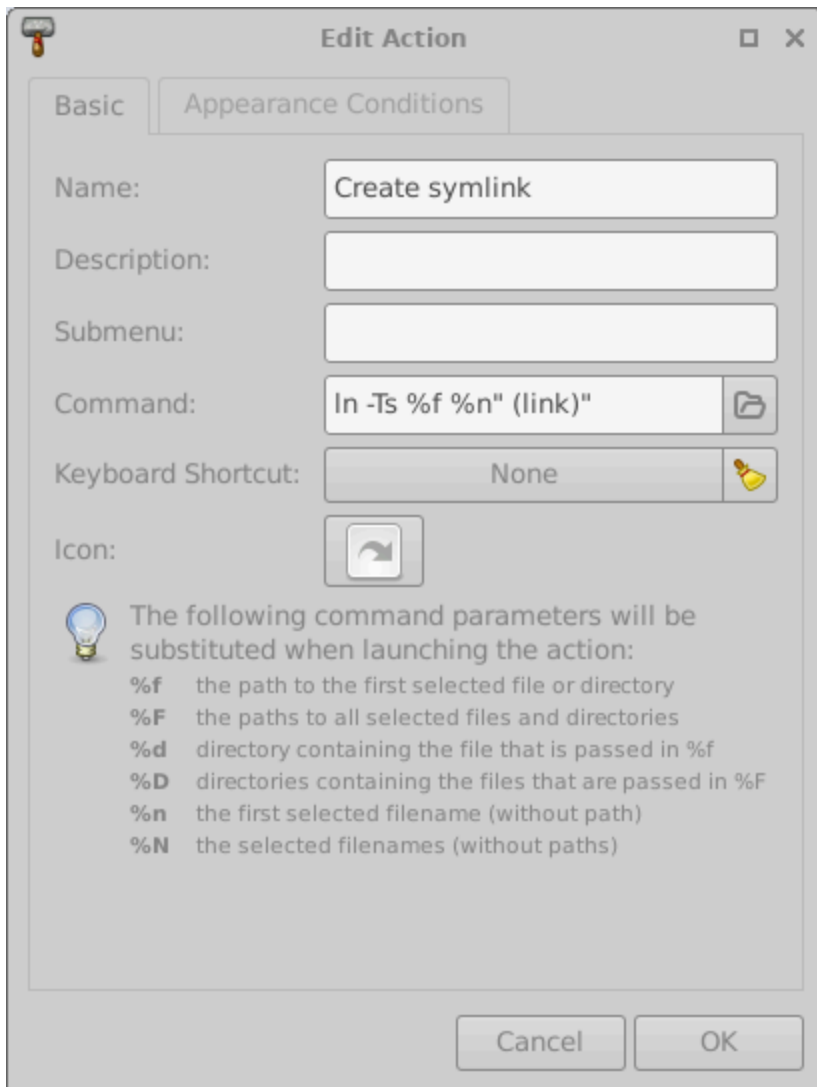
This page serves as an introduction to the **Custom Actions** plugin, and includes a list of useful examples.

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Adding a Custom Action

This section provides a step-by-step introduction to the **Custom Actions** plugin, demonstrating how to add a simple action. We start by opening the **Custom Actions** dialog as explained above. In the dialog, click on the first button in the list of buttons (the one labeled with the +). The **Create Action** dialog will appear, as shown in the screenshot below.

Create Custom Action Dialog



On the first page, enter `Create symlink` in **Name**: Enter `ln -Ts %f %n\" (link)\"` for the **Command**: (the `%f` will be replaced with the path to the selected file, as explained in the dialog), and select an icon by clicking **Icon**: (in the screenshot `emblem-symbolic-link` was used).

Optionally, you can specify a **Submenu**:, in order to group multiple custom actions into the same menu.

Never quote field codes, unless you know why [particularly true if their expansion contains quotes, but not only]

Always quote shell variable expansions, unless you know why [classical shell programming advice, but it might be useful to recall here]

When a field code appears in quotes, you can generally extract it and concatenate:

```
cmd "foo %f bar" (wrong) ->; cmd "foo "%f" bar" (correct)
```

Or you can put its content in a shell variable and use this variable instead:

```
cmd "foo %f bar" (wrong) ->; f=%f; cmd "foo $f bar" (correct)
```

In case of multiple arguments, you can safely use a for loop in that way:

```
for f in %F; do cmd "foo $f bar"; done
```

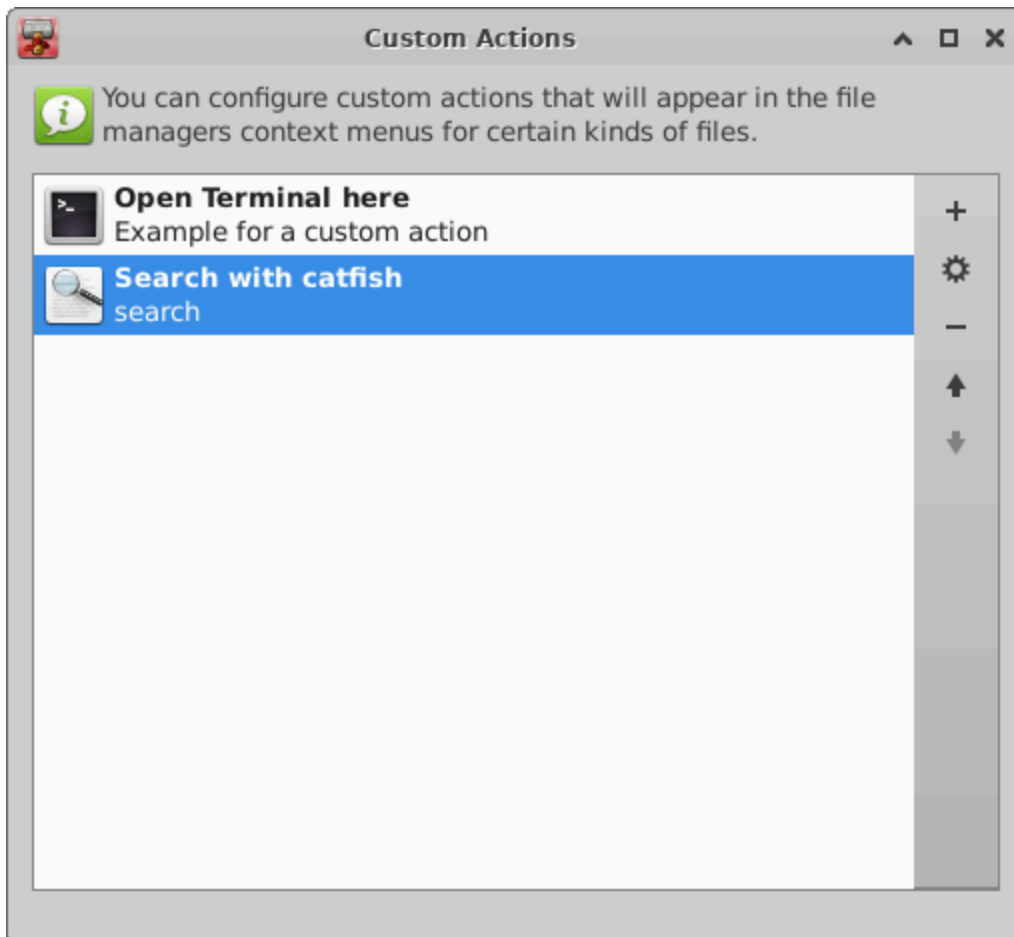
Now, continue with the second page (the **Appearance Conditions** page).

We want to create an action that is only applicable to folders, so select the **Folders** options and unselect the options for the other file types. Next you can specify a **File Pattern** to display the action only for text files that match a certain pattern. In the example, we set the file pattern to * (which matches all filenames) to indicate that the action should be displayed for all folders.

That's all. Click **OK** to close the **Create Action** dialog. The new action, labeled **Search with Catfish** will appear in the **Custom Actions** list.

Now close the **Custom Actions** dialog, select a folder in Thunar and open the context menu (right-click on the file icon). The newly created **Search with Catfish** action will appear in the context menu, as shown in the screenshot below.

Custom Actions List Dialog



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Using mnemonics to open Custom Actions

When you create a Thunar Custom Action you can set the name with an underscore “_” before a letter to use it as mnemonic. When you right click in a Thunar view, you can type the letter to access your custom action.

Examples

Here are a few useful examples of custom actions. Feel free to extend this list.

Search files with catfish

- Name: **Search files in folder**
- Command: `catfish %f`

- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories

Note: For this action, you'll need to have `catfish` installed, which is part of the `catfish` package.

Work with archives (tar, gzip, etc)

- Name: **Extract here (bzip2)**
- Command: `tar xjf %n`
- File pattern: `*.tar.bz2;*.tbz2`
- Appears if selection contains: Other Files
- Name: **Extract here (zip)**
- Command: `unzip %f`
- File pattern: `*.zip`
- Appears if selection contains: Other Files
- Name: **Create tar.gz from folder**
- Command: `tar czvf %n.tar.gz %n`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories

Hint: You may prefer the [Thunar Archive Plugin](#), which does pretty much the same thing with less manual setup required on your part. It's either included with your distribution (in the case of [Xubuntu](#)), or available as a separate package (`thunar-archive-plugin` in Debian Etch). You might also need the `xarchiver` or “squeeze” package for things to work quite right.

Play/Enqueue music files

- Name: **Play with XMMS**
- Command: `xmms %F`
- File pattern: *

- Appears if selection contains: Directories, Audio Files
- Name: **Enqueue in XMMS**
- Command: `xmms -e %F`
- File pattern: `*`
- Appears if selection contains: Directories, Audio Files

Hint: Works exactly the same with Audacious.

Convert PNGs to JPEGs

- Name: **Convert to JPEG**
- Command: `convert %f -quality 75 %f.jpg`
- File pattern: `*.png`
- Appears if selection contains: Image Files

Hint: `"$(basename %f .png) .jpg"` will strip the old .png extension off of the original filename.

Rotate JPEGs

- Name: **Rotate Clockwise**
- Command: `for file in %F; do exiftran -i9 "$file"; done`
- Command(counter-clockwise): `for file in %F; do exiftran -i2 "$file"; done`
- File pattern: `*.jpg;*.JPG;*.jpeg;*.JPEG`
- Appears if selection contains: JPEG Image Files

Note: exiftran is available for most distributions.

Open terminal here

- Name: **Open terminal here**
- Command 1: `for f in %F; do exo-open --working-directory "$f" --launch TerminalEmulator; done`

- Command 2: `for f in %F; do if [ -d "$f" ]; then exo-open --working-directory "$f" --launch TerminalEmulator; elif [ -z "$default" ]; then default=1; exo-open --launch TerminalEmulator; fi done`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: any

Command 1 will open a terminal on all selected folder.

Command 2 in addition will open a terminal on the current directory, when executed on a non-folder files (or multiple)

Open root terminal here

- Name: **Open root terminal here**
- Command(1): `pkexec env DISPLAY=$DISPLAY XAUTHORITY=$XAUTHORITY dbus-launch xfce4-terminal --default-working-directory=%f`
- Command(2): `gksu xfce4-terminal --default-working-directory=%f`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories

Note: Use either pkexec or gksu, depending on what is available for your distro.

Note: You should rewrite the command with normal straight quotes.

Open thunar as root here

- Name: **Open thunar as root here**
- Command(1): `pkexec env DISPLAY=$DISPLAY XAUTHORITY=$XAUTHORITY dbus-launch thunar %f`
- Command(2): `thunar admin:///%f`
- Command(3): `gksu thunar %f`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories

Note: Some distributions no longer include gksu. Use pkexec or the admin interface instead.

Edit file as root

- Name: **Edit as root**
- Command(1): `pkexec env DISPLAY=$DISPLAY XAUTHORITY=$XAUTHORITY dbus-launch put-your-favourite-text-editor-here %f`
- Command(2): `gksu put-your-favourite-text-editor-here %f`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Text files

Note: You'll need to replace put-your-favourite-text-editor-here with your favourite text editor (e.g. mousepad or geany). Also, see previous note about gksu.

Create a symbolic link

- Name: **Create symlink**
- Command: `ln -Ts %f %n" (symlink)"`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories, other files

Create a hardlink

- Name: **Create hardlink**
- Command: `ln %f %n" (hardlink)"`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories, other files

View disk usage of the current directory

- Name: **Disk Usage**
- Command: `baobab %d`
- File pattern: *

- Appears if selection contains: Tick all the boxes

Note: The idea is to get a visual picture of the current directory and any subdirectories. You could also use `fsview` or `filelight`, but the visuals are crisper in `baobab`.

Open file in terminal text editor

- Name: **Open in Terminal**
- Command: `xfce4-terminal -x editor %f`
- File pattern: *
- Appearance Conditions: Text files

Compare selected files/directories

- Name: **Compare**
- Command: `meld %F`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Directories and Text files

Note: You will need the `meld` package.

Change OpenDocument-supported formats

Note: You will need `unoconv` package for all following actions.

- Name: **Convert to ODT**
- Command: `unoconv -f odt %F`
- File pattern: `*.doc;*.docx`
- Appears if selection contains: Other files
- Name: **Export to PDF**
- Command: `unoconv -f pdf %F`
- File pattern: `*.doc;*.docx;*.odt;*.odp;*.pps;*.ppt;*.xls;*.xlsx;*.ods;*.pptx`
- Appears if selection contains: Other files

You can go on, try `man unoconv` for details.

Download video subtitles

- Name: **Download subtitles**
- Command: `~/local/bin/OpenSubtitlesDownload.py --gui=gnome %F`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Video Files

Note: You will need to follow the instructions on [OpenSubtitlesDownload](#) which requires python and zenity (check the link for a complete list of requirements). You can tweak the behavior of the python script simply by editing with a text editor, the code is all commented, so it is very easy to understand.

Rename subtitles easily

- Name: **Rename subtitles**
- Description: Select video and subtitles file. Subtitles will be renamed based on the video name.
- Command: `subnm %F`
- File pattern: `*.avi;*.mp4;*.crdownload;*.srt;*.sub`
- Appears if selection contains: Video Files, Text Files, Other Files

Note: You will need `subnm` script. Get it [here](#). You'll also need zenity package.

Move files into a new folder

- Name: **Move into new folder**
- Description: Select any number of file/folders. A dialog will popup in which you can write the name of a new folder to create. Selected Files will be moved there.
- Command: `NEW_FOLDER=$(/usr/bin/zenity --entry --title 'Move into new folder' --text 'Please enter a name for the new folder') && mkdir "$NEW_FOLDER" && mv %F "$NEW_FOLDER"`
- File pattern: *

- Appears if selection contains: All

Note: You'll will need the zenity package.

Create Shared Thumbnails

- Name: **Create shared thumbnails**
- Description: Creates [shared thumbnails](#) for the selected folder and all subfolders via DBus Thumbnailing service.
- Command: `/path/to/script/sharedx.sh %f`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: Folders

Note: Required to download a thumbnail generation script. Candidates are:

Attention: Read and use external thumbnail generation scripts with caution! They are not part of Xfce and are not tested / reviewed.

Use 'bulk rename' on a single file

- Name: **Open in bulk renamer**
- Description: Opens the bulk renamer for a single file
- Command: `thunar --bulk-rename %f`
- File pattern: *
- Appears if selection contains: any
- Range: 1-1

Trust multiple desktop files at once

- Name: **Trust Desktop Files**
- Description: Sets gvfs checksum and +x flag for all selected *.desktop files
- Command: `for f in %F; do sha256sum "$f" | awk '{print $1}' | xargs gio set "$f" metadata::xfce-exe-checksum && chmod +x "$f"; done`
- File pattern: *.desktop

- Appears if selection contains: other files
- Range: 1-1

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